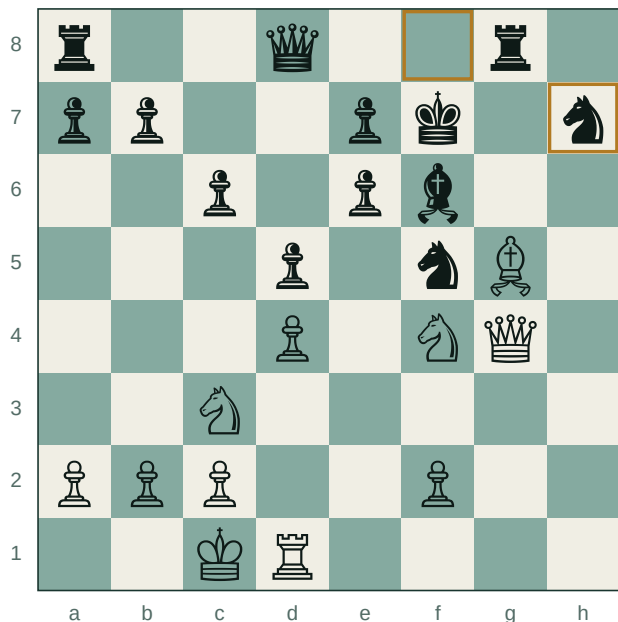


Deflection tactics: White, move 19

Deflection tactics

White to move



Previous move: 18...Nxh7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

19. Qh5+ Kg7 20. Nxe6+

19.Qh5+ Check restricts Black to 3 legal replies here. From h5 it attacks king on f7 and knight on h7. Recorded reply: **19...Kg7**.

20.Nxe6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From e6 it attacks king on g7 and queen on d8.

At the end, nominal material is White 28 / Black 33 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -6 to -5. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A replacement defender or an intermediate check can keep the target safe even after the original defender moves.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Deflection distracts a defender from a critical job. Its new square matters less than the fact that it no longer guards the original target.

HOW TO LOOK

Name the defender's job, find a forcing way to divert it, and calculate the move that exploits the abandoned square.

The defending king is on f7. Geometrically undefended: knight on h7. Check for tactical protection.